

# THE GLACIER WAS GOD'S GREAT PLOW

## ANCIENT ICE AGES

### IN CONTEXT

KEY FIGURE

**Louis Agassiz** (1807–73)

BEFORE

**1795** Scottish geologist James Hutton argues that erratic boulders (rock fragments that are different from the underlying rock) in the Alps were transported by moving glaciers.

**1818** In Sweden, naturalist Göran Wahlenburg publishes his theory that ice once covered Scandinavia.

**1824** Danish–Norwegian mineralogist Jens Esmark theorizes that glaciers were once larger and thicker and had covered much of Norway and the adjacent seafloor.

AFTER

**1938** Serbian mathematician Milutin Milankovic´ publishes a theory to explain the recurrence of ice ages based on changes in Earth's orbit around the Sun.

In the early 19th century, there were contradictory explanations for the development of Earth's landforms, plants, and animals. Supporters of catastrophism argued that a series of destructive shocks, such as the Great